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Championed by ASUC EAVP, AB 2608 will update sexual violence trainings for California colleges | State | dailycal.org

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Saanvi Arora, the newly elected ASUC External Affairs Vice President, or EAVP, has co-written and introduced a bill that will update sexual violence and harassment training in California colleges.

Passed by the California State Legislature and signed into law by Gov. Gavin Newsom on July 15, AB 2608 will directly affect UC Berkeley. Arora pitched the bill to Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel after working with the UC Student Association and her ASUC team. The bill was officially introduced in January.

The bill will amend the California Education Code to require all California colleges in the California State University and California Community Colleges systems to provide critical updates to the statewide framework for sexual violence and harassment training for incoming students, and it will request University of California schools to do the same.

“I want students to feel more empowered to seek support from the university if they need it, but also know what support is available and is there for them in these circumstances, both from a preventive but also from a reactive treatment perspective,” Arora said. “So hopefully, the educational training that is incorporated will be student-vetted.”

According to the bill’s language, the trainings’ information will be updated by Sep. 1 — and again by Sep. 1, 2026 — to include more comprehensive information on sexual violence and harassment.

This information will include responsive and preventative measures for “alcohol-and-drug-facilitated sexual assault,” victim resources, indentity-based statistics, consequences of sexual violence perpetrators and common facts and myths regarding sexual violence.

“There’s been more of a focus on how substance use intersects with sexual violence,” Arora said. “On college campuses, while we might be equipped with knowledge to respond to or understand substance use and what safe and responsible consumption is, it’s hard to understand or remain aware when you might be at risk of violence due to involuntary intoxication.”

The bill requests that the University of California Board of Regents enact these new educational and preventative measures of sexual violence information in collaboration with campus-based and community-based victim advocacy organizations.

Arora noted that this change is important because mandatory trainings often neglect to explicitly mention that consent requires sobriety and because victims lack visible resources.

“While we do already have trainings when you come to UC Berkeley about stopping and responding to sexual violence, drugged sexual assault isn’t explicitly talked about, even though it is a pressing issue for students,” said Pradeep Kundu, ASUC student and state government relations director.

Kundu helped Arora by publicizing and advocating for the bill through lobbying and giving speeches about the bill’s significance.

Kundu hopes the bill will be implemented at UC Berkeley in a campus-specific manner. He also hopes to see more consistent, campus-wide communication about resources for victims of sexual violence so that they can feel more

informed and empowered.

“One of the things we’ll be doing as an office is looking at whether UC Berkeley complies with what we specifically said in the bill,” Kundu said. “This bill is very important, so we’ll be looking to see how Berkeley goes about it.”

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